

Mission Control: Task Board & Calendar

OpenClaw Masterclass — Lesson Guide & All Prompts

What you'll build in this lesson:

- Task Board — kanban board with drag-and-drop, assignees, priorities, tags, and live activity feed
- Calendar — weekly view of real OpenClaw cron jobs, colour coded, auto-refreshing
- Heartbeat wiring — agent automatically picks up tasks from the board
- PM2 process manager — keeps Mission Control running and auto-restarts on crash

All Prompts Used In This Lesson

Copy and paste these prompts into Telegram in order.

Prompt 1: Build the Task Board

Add a Task Board screen to our Mission Control. Make it a kanban board with these columns: Backlog, In Progress, Review, and Done. Every task should show a title, a description, who it's assigned to — that could be me, you, or any sub-agent — a priority level like High or Medium, tags, and an ETA. I want to be able to add new tasks, edit them, delete them, and drag them between columns. Add a live activity feed on the right side that shows everything you and your agents are doing in detail so I can track your progress. Save everything with server-side persistence so tasks don't disappear. Also add filtering at the top so I can filter tasks by who they're assigned to. After making the changes, rebuild for production and restart the server.

After the agent confirms, refresh your dashboard and click Task Board in the sidebar.

Prompt 2: Fix Card Styling (if needed)

The task board columns are too narrow and the cards don't have enough space. Make the columns wider so titles fit properly. Also drag and drop between columns isn't working — fix that so I can drag tasks from one column to another.

Use this if cards look cramped or drag-and-drop doesn't work. You can also send a screenshot to your agent to show what needs fixing.

Tip: Show your agent what needs fixing. You can take a screenshot of the dashboard (Cmd+Shift+4 on Mac, Win+Shift+S on Windows), drag it into Telegram, and type what you want changed. The agent will see exactly what you see and fix it much faster than describing the problem in words.

Example: Adding a Task Through the Dashboard

To test the Task Board, try adding a task with these values:

Field	Example Value
Title	Set up weekly client report automation
ETA	Next Friday
Description	Build an automated weekly report that summarises all client project updates and sends it every Friday morning

Tags	automation, clients
Assignee	Ace
Column	Backlog
Priority	High

Click **Add task** and the task will appear in the Backlog column with all the details.

Prompt 3: Add a Task via Telegram

Add a task to the Mission Control board: Research competitor pricing for AI consulting. Assign it to yourself, set it as High priority.

You can add tasks from Telegram without opening the dashboard. Refresh the browser to see the new task.

Prompt 4: Set Up Heartbeat Task Pickup

On every heartbeat, check our Mission Control task board. If there are any tasks assigned to you in the Backlog, pick them up and start working on them. Move them to In Progress when you start, and to Done when you finish. Update the activity feed as you go.

The agent may say it needs to wire this properly. If so, use the next prompt.

Prompt 5: Wire Heartbeat Automation

Yes, build the actual wiring so heartbeats automatically read the task board, find tasks assigned to you in the Backlog, pick them up, move them to In Progress, and mark them Done when completed. Update the activity feed as you go.

Prompt 6: Build the Calendar Screen

Add a Calendar screen to our Mission Control. Show all my real cron jobs and scheduled tasks from OpenClaw in a weekly view. Each task should be colour coded and show the name and the time it's scheduled for. Also show an Always Running section at the top for any recurring background tasks. Pull the data from the real OpenClaw cron list so we're seeing actual scheduled jobs, not mock data. Refresh the data every 30 seconds.

Prompt 7: Fix Calendar Parsing (if needed)

The Calendar is showing 'Unparsed job' and 'unknown' for all the cron jobs. Fix the parsing so it shows the actual job names and scheduled times. Also give each job a different colour so they're easy to tell apart.

Use this if the Calendar shows placeholder names instead of real job names.

Keeping Mission Control Running (PM2)

Mission Control can sometimes crash when the environment kills background processes. To prevent this, we use pm2 — a process manager that keeps the server running and auto-restarts it.

If Mission Control crashes, tell your agent:

Mission Control is down. Restart it on port 3007 in production mode.

To set up PM2 (if not already done):

Use a local process manager that doesn't need elevated access to keep Mission Control running. Something like `npx pm2` or a simple restart loop. Just make sure it stays up permanently.

Note: PM2 installed locally inside the project will keep Mission Control running during normal use. However, if the Docker container is destroyed and recreated (e.g. after a deploy in Hostinger), you'll need to tell your agent to restart Mission Control again.

For a fully permanent solution (optional):

SSH into your server, enter the Docker container, and install pm2 globally:

```
ssh root@YOUR_TAILSCALE_IP
docker exec -it CONTAINER_ID /bin/bash
npm install -g pm2
cd /data/.openclaw/workspace/mission-control
PORT=3007 pm2 start npm --name mission-control -- start
pm2 save
```

Tips & Troubleshooting

Situation	What to do
Mission Control crashed	Tell your agent: 'Mission Control is down. Restart it on port 3007 in production mode.'
Task cards look cramped or ugly	Send a screenshot to your agent and describe what needs fixing. The agent will update the styling.
Drag and drop not working	Tell the agent to fix drag and drop between columns. This sometimes needs explicit wiring.
Calendar shows 'Unparsed job'	Tell the agent to fix the cron parsing so it shows real job names and times.
All calendar jobs same colour	Tell the agent to give each job a different colour so they're easy to tell apart.
Task added via Telegram not showing	Refresh your browser (Cmd+R or Ctrl+R). The dashboard doesn't auto-refresh the task board.
Agent says it can't install pm2 globally	Ask it to use a local install instead: 'Use a local process manager that doesn't need elevated access.'
Heartbeat not picking up tasks	Ask the agent to wire it: 'Build the actual wiring so heartbeats automatically read the task board.'
Browser shows 'connection refused'	Check if the SSH tunnel is still open. If not, re-run: <code>ssh -N -L 3007:127.0.0.1:3007 root@TAILSCALE_IP</code>

Calendar Verification Tip

Any time you tell your agent to schedule something, come back to the Calendar screen and check that it actually appeared. If you don't see it, tell your agent:

You said you'd schedule that task but I don't see it on the Calendar. Set it up properly.

Pro tip: The Calendar is your source of truth. If a cron job isn't on the Calendar, it's not actually scheduled. Use it to hold your agent accountable.

What You've Built

- ✓ Task Board with kanban columns (Backlog, In Progress, Review, Done)
- ✓ Add, edit, delete, and drag tasks between columns
- ✓ Filter tasks by assignee (you, agent, sub-agents)
- ✓ Live activity feed tracking all board changes
- ✓ Add tasks from Telegram without opening the dashboard
- ✓ Heartbeat auto-pickup — agent works through tasks automatically
- ✓ Calendar showing real OpenClaw cron jobs in weekly view
- ✓ Colour-coded jobs with auto-refresh every 30 seconds
- ✓ PM2 process manager keeping Mission Control stable